

Remote Work & Hybrid Workplace Policy

Guidelines for Distributed Teams, Equipment, and Security

1. Policy Overview and Remote Eligibility

ACME Corporation supports flexible remote work arrangements for positions categorized as Remote-Eligible or Hybrid.

Eligibility Requirements: Employees must have completed at least 3 months of full-time tenure and maintain a performance rating of 3.5 or higher on their quarterly reviews.

Employees in specialized operational or on-site facility roles are not eligible for full remote status.

2. Hybrid Schedule and In-Office Mandate

Hybrid employees are required to work from their assigned regional office a minimum of 2 days per week: designated anchor days are Tuesday and Thursday.

Core Collaboration Hours: All remote and hybrid team members must be online and reachable between 10:00 AM and 4:00 PM in their primary team timezone.

Attendance at quarterly on-site departmental summits and annual all-hands meetings is mandatory for all full remote employees.

3. Home Workspace and Ergonomic Requirements

Remote employees are responsible for maintaining a dedicated, quiet, and secure home workspace free from background noise during business calls.

Internet Connectivity: A stable broadband internet connection with a minimum of 50 Mbps download and 15 Mbps upload speed is required.

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4. Equipment Allowance and Tech Provisioning

Hardware Package: Each employee receives a standard corporate laptop (MacBook Pro 14" or ThinkPad T14) and security accessories upon hire.

Home Office Setup Stipend: A one-time non-taxable stipend of \$800 is provided to purchase an ergonomic desk, monitor, chair, or keyboard within the first 60 days of employment.

Annual Technology Refresher: Remote employees are eligible for an annual allowance of \$300 for computer peripherals, cables, and headsets.

Equipment Lifecycle: Company-issued laptops are scheduled for hardware replacement and upgrade every 36 months.

5. Monthly Internet and Utility Reimbursement

Eligible full-time remote employees receive a flat monthly internet allowance of \$75 processed automatically through bi-weekly payroll.

Hybrid employees working at least 2 days remote per week receive an internet subsidy of \$40 per month.

6. Cybersecurity and Confidentiality Standards

Company VPN connection is strictly mandatory when connecting to internal servers, customer databases, or staging environments.

Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) via hardware security key or authenticator app is mandatory across all corporate accounts.

Working from public unsecured Wi-Fi networks (cafes, airports) without active VPN encryption is strictly prohibited.

Family members and unauthorized individuals must never be permitted to access or use company-owned equipment.

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7. Work from Anywhere (Temporary Relocation)

Employees may request to work from an alternative domestic or international location for up to 30 calendar days per fiscal year.

Requests must be submitted to People Operations and Legal at least 21 days in advance to verify tax jurisdiction and visa regulations.

Temporary relocation to sanctioned countries or regions with high travel advisories is strictly prohibited.

8. Communication and Availability Standards

Slack Status: Employees must update their Slack availability status to reflect lunch breaks, focused working blocks, and out-of-office periods.

Response Time Expectations: Urgent direct messages should be acknowledged within 60 minutes during core hours; standard emails within 24 business hours.

Video Camera Policy: Cameras should be enabled for one-on-one reviews and client presentations; optional for large webinars.

9. Policy Compliance and Revocation

Remote work is a performance-linked privilege. If an employee fails to meet key performance indicators (KPIs < 80% for two consecutive months), manager intervention may mandate returning to full-time office work.